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The takeaway: A recent routing study offers a useful test design for Banff/Canmore: compare kilometres at equivalent overflow performance before putting projected savings into a budget.

No major new development to highlight today.

Research spotlight — compare routes at equal service

Published November 4, 2026, a study from Vellore Institute of Technology models a system that processes bin readings locally and selects collection stops dynamically. In its 28-day simulation, mean daily distance fell from 102.67 to 63.81 km, a 37.9% reduction across 30 replicates. The comparator was the cheapest fixed collection cadence with a matching overflow rate; the two policies used the same routing algorithm. Study, section 5.4.

All bin data were synthetic, and no physical prototype was deployed. This is a simulated distance result, with travel time under congestion outside scope. It does not establish a local fuel, staffing or budget saving. For a Banff/Canmore trial, pair distance with overflow events and staff time; shorter routes alone would be an incomplete success measure.

Research spotlight — separate preventable food from unavoidable scraps

Accepted October 26, 2026, a study of six Czech municipalities describes manual sorting of 500-kg residual-waste samples into 23 categories, including avoidable and unavoidable food waste, with a model correcting for moisture loss. Its proposed screening index divides avoidable food waste by unavoidable food waste, rather than by total residual waste. Study abstract.

The abstract reports an isolated late-summer surge in discarded edible items. That supports a practical audit question: would a different sampling season change the apparent prevention opportunity? The final formatted article is still pending, so these methods warrant examination before adoption. The Czech findings do not supply a Banff/Canmore baseline.

Worth acting on

Before the next local audit, specify the denominator for each food-waste indicator and retain season identifiers alongside the results. Use local measurements to decide whether a pilot is justified.